

4th Taube Centre Annual Conference, 8–9 June 2026

Faculty of International and Political Studies, JU, ul. Reymonta 4, room 207

DEMOCRACY AND TRUST IN TIMES OF CHANGING WORLD ORDER

8 JUNE (MONDAY)

9:00–9:30 WELCOME COFFEE

9:30–9:45 OFFICIAL OPENING

- Piotr Bajor – Dean of the Faculty of International and Political Studies
- Shana Penn – Taube Philanthropies Executive Director
- Paweł Laidler – Taube Centre Director

9:45–10:15 TAD TAUBE: IN MEMORIAM

- Shana Penn and Paweł Laidler

10:15–11:15 KEYNOTE I

- Alex Dukalskis (University College Dublin): *The Authoritarian Resurgence in World Politics*

11:15–13:00 PANEL I – Authoritarian populism, trust and international cooperation

CHAIR: Magdalena Góra

- Helene Sjursen (Oslo University): *Strategic Autonomy and authoritarian populism*
- Lucia Frigo (Royal Holloway) *The Unpredictable Leaders' Intelligence cooperation: UK-US intelligence sharing under Trump's second mandate*
- Marianna Lovato (Jagiellonian University): *Paying the price of authoritarian populism: Trump 2.0 and international solidarity towards Ukraine*

13:00–14:30 LUNCH

14:30–16:30 PANEL II – Populism, Institutional Transformation, and Democratic Resilience in Central and Eastern Europe

CHAIR: Zdzisław Mach

- Marta Żerkowska-Balas (SWPS University): *Why Can't We Just "Go Back"? Trapped Democracy and the Populist Appeal*
- Stanley Bill (University of Cambridge): *Debates over Democracy: Interchanging Narratives of De- and Re-Democratization in Poland*
- Ben Stanley (SWPS University): *Postliberalism, post-illiberalism: attitudes in Poland after the Good Change*
- Paulina Lenik (Jagiellonian University): *The Cultural Consolidation of PiS Voters: Understanding the Electoral Base of Populism in Poland*

19:00 DINNER

9 JUNE 2026 TUESDAY

9:30–10:00 WELCOME COFFEE

10:00–11:45 PANEL III – Challenges of Democracy in the Balkan Region

CHAIR: Natasza Styczyńska

- Aleksandra Dragojlov (Kaunas University of Technology): *Democratic Resilience and the Fight Against Corruption: Symbols of the Anti-Government Protests and their Representation in the Serbian Media.*
- Aleksandra Zdeb (University of the National Education Commission in Kraków): *Consociationalism and its Unintended Consequences in Bosnia and Herzegovina, Kosovo, and North Macedonia. Appetite for Destruction?*
- Adam Fagan (King's College London): *Fair is foul, and foul is fair? Examining Support for Different Understandings of Fairness Among Judicial Practitioners in the Western Balkans*

11:45–12:45 KEYNOTE II

- Jan Kubik (Rutgers University): *Why are Polish and Czech populisms so different? Divergent Historical Roots of today's political cultures*

12:45–13:00 SUMMARY AND WRAP-UP

- Paweł Laidler / Zdzisław Mach

13:00 LUNCH

15:00 Guided tour of Wawel Castle